Start with the work you want

This guide helps you find current openings and compare them against your own priorities. Use the same brief whether you search yourself or ask an AI assistant for help. You do not need a custom agent or a ready-made list of employers.

Carry your experience into the search

If you have already worked through your experience and preferences with AI, reuse that summary. Otherwise, describe the responsibilities you want, relevant experience and scope, and where you can work. Start from the work itself; possible job titles help you search, but the full description is what you assess.

Separate requirements from preferences

A requirement is a condition a role must meet for you to consider it. A preference matters but can trade off against something else. For example, remote work might be required for one person and preferred for another. Do not let a tool make that choice for you. If the posting is unclear, leave the requirement unconfirmed rather than assuming it passes or fails.

Your reusable search brief

Work or roles to explore: [responsibilities and directions]
Relevant experience: [short summary, including scope]
Possible titles: [optional search terms]
Location and work arrangement: [where and how you can work]
Requirements: [conditions a role must meet]
Preferences: [what matters but could flex]
Criteria and weights: [complete using page 2]
Sources or employers to include: [optional]
Saved openings still under consideration: [optional links]

Choose how to run the search

- With AI: prepare the brief, then send the prompt on page 3 to an assistant with current web access.
- By yourself: use the same brief and follow the search and comparison steps on page 4.

Use the starter if it helps

The Job Search Starter collects your brief and prepares an AI prompt or a manual plan. It does not search the web, score actual openings or create a schedule. The copyable instructions in this guide also work on their own. Only provide material you are allowed to share; leave out confidential work and other people’s private information.

Open the Job Search Starter

Make the tradeoffs visible

Weights express how much each criterion matters to you. Scores describe how an opening measures up against those criteria. Decide the criteria and what the scores mean before comparing roles.

Choose a few criteria and define the scale

Use a 1 to 5 scale: 1 means weak but still acceptable, 3 means acceptable, and 5 means strong for you. Use 2 or 4 between those anchors. Define the anchors for each criterion, using your own expectations. Keep confirmed failures of firm requirements outside this comparison.

Three criteria for this fictional example

Work fit means the match between desired responsibilities and relevant experience at that scope. Compensation compares the same pay basis: 1 is near the lowest acceptable amount, 3 meets the target and 5 is substantially above it. Work arrangement ranges from workable but inconvenient (1), through acceptable (3), to the preferred location and office expectations (5).

Compare two fictional openings

This person wants project coordination work. Both roles meet their firm requirements and are within their demonstrated scope. These invented posting details explain the example scores. In your search, record actual evidence for each score.

Criterion	Weight	Role A	Role B
Work fit	50%	4: mostly project coordination; some administration	3: coordination plus substantial fundraising they do not want
Compensation	30%	3: posted base pay meets their target	5: posted base pay is well above their target
Work arrangement	20%	5: remote from their eligible location	2: office days require a difficult but acceptable commute

A: (4 × 0.50) + (3 × 0.30) + (5 × 0.20) = 3.9 / 5
B: (3 × 0.50) + (5 × 0.30) + (2 × 0.20) = 3.4 / 5

Change the priorities and the order can change

If compensation matters more, try weights of 30% fit, 50% compensation and 20% arrangement. The same component scores give A 3.7 and B 3.8. B now comes first. The jobs did not change; the priorities did. Choose your own weights and make sure they add to 100%.

Leave unknowns visible

If a weighted criterion is unknown, leave its score and the overall total blank. Do not use zero or redistribute its weight. Keep the role in a “needs information” group with the question to resolve. A score helps compare options; it is not a prediction of a job offer. Close totals are a reason to inspect the tradeoffs.

Ask AI to find and compare openings

Send this prompt and your completed brief to an assistant with current web access. If it cannot browse, use page 4. The starter's generated prompt includes your brief.

Copy this prompt, add your brief, then send it

Find current openings using my search brief below. Ask about unclear firm requirements before excluding roles. If criterion definitions or weights are missing, propose them for my agreement before scoring. Weights must total 100%. You can discover leads while we clarify criteria. Choose a manageable search scope and report it.

Search employer careers pages, relevant job boards and the wider web. Try title variants based on the work I want. Include leads I provide, but do not assume access to my accounts.

Find each promising role on the employer's site. Read the full description and check whether applications are open. Record the employer link, job ID if available, date checked and discovery source. Separate unverified discoveries and explain what remains unchecked. Combine duplicates of the same vacancy.

Compare verified new and still-active saved openings together. Check firm requirements separately: exclude only confirmed failures, show why, and keep unclear conditions unconfirmed. For each weighted criterion, show posting evidence, your reasoning and a 1 to 5 score against my definitions. Do not treat missing information as missing ability.

Compare compensation on the same stated basis, such as posted base pay. Do not treat base pay as total compensation or guess bonus and equity. Flag ranges and missing details.

Leave unknown scores blank. Keep those roles in a needs-information group with questions; do not calculate their total or redistribute their weights. For complete roles, multiply each score by its weight as a decimal, add the results and rank the combined list. Explain the tradeoff behind the order. Scores are not hiring probabilities.

Return responsibilities, requirement status, component scores and evidence, total where supported, questions and suggested next action. Show which sources you checked and could not access. Do not apply or contact anyone.

MY SEARCH BRIEF:
[Add the completed brief from page 1.]

Read a few postings yourself

Follow a few employer links and check the actual work, scope and evidence behind the scores. Correct assumptions about your experience or preferences. You can open inaccessible sources yourself and provide relevant leads.

Know what the search covered

A source the assistant could not access remains unchecked. No suitable results in the checked sources is different from an incomplete or failed search.

Run the same search yourself

Use a notes document or spreadsheet with one row per opening. The method is the same: find leads in several places, check the employer's description, then compare new and saved opportunities against your brief.

Search for responsibilities and title variants

For someone who wants project coordination work, try separate queries such as "project coordinator [location] jobs" and "program coordinator [location] careers". Read the descriptions to see what those titles mean. If the results miss the work, try a responsibility phrase such as "project scheduling [location] jobs".

Choose several relevant sources

Use a general job board or web search alongside employer careers pages and a relevant specialist or local board. Search "[field] job board [location]" to discover sources. Include saved openings, alerts and roles people send you. LinkedIn can be one source; you do not need to build the search around it.

Find the employer's posting

When a lead looks promising, locate the same vacancy on the employer's site. Read the full description and check whether applications are open. Save the direct link, job ID if available and date checked. A general careers page or search snippet is not verification of that vacancy. Keep an unverified lead separate for follow-up.

Compare new and saved openings together

Check firm requirements first and flag anything unclear. Use the criteria, anchors and weights you chose on page 2. Record a short reason and evidence for each component score. Calculate totals only when all weighted criteria are supported. Put roles with unknown scores in a needs-information group; they may still be worth pursuing.

A row you can copy

Employer and role: [name and title]
Employer posting / job ID: [link / ID if available]
Found through / checked on: [source / date]
Requirements: [met, confirmed failure or unconfirmed, with evidence]
Criteria: [each score, posting evidence and reasoning]
Weighted total: [calculate only if complete]
Unanswered questions: [what could change your decision]
Next action: [investigate, apply or pass]

Choose where to spend your effort

Read the reasons behind the order before deciding. A higher total does not settle every tradeoff, especially when the scores are close. You can also ask AI to compare postings you found yourself using the prompt on page 3, while making clear that you have already supplied the leads.

Refine the search, then repeat it

Test the search before making it recurring. Use the first results to improve the terms, sources and interpretation of your priorities. If the results keep missing the work, revisit the role directions against your experience.

Tell AI what was useful and what missed

Use our latest agreed brief and criteria. Review these results:
Worth exploring, if any: [link and why].
Missed the point, if any: [link and why].
If there were no results: [what I expected to find].

Explain whether the problem is search terms, source coverage, missing information or how you applied my criteria. Propose specific changes and ask me to confirm them. Do not silently change my requirements, weights or score definitions. Once confirmed, use the revised brief for the next search.

Keep comparisons consistent

Add new openings to the still-active saved list and reorder it. Do not change an existing component score merely because another role arrived. Reassess when relevant information, your experience or your criteria change, and record why. If you change weights, recalculate all complete totals with the new weights.

Choose a routine that fits your search

Enable useful job alerts where available, bookmark employer searches and set a reminder, or use a recurring AI task if your tool and account support it. You can combine these. The starter can prepare a repeat request; you must send it to a tool that can create the schedule.

A repeat request for a tool with scheduling

Repeat the search we tested on [days] at [time] in [time zone]. Use our latest agreed brief, criteria and weights; return results here. If the brief changed after the trial, test the revised version before scheduling it.

Compare new openings with the saved ones you can still access. Preserve existing scores unless relevant evidence or criteria changed; explain any changes. Keep unknowns visible. Include the date, employer links and sources you could not check. Distinguish no relevant results from an incomplete or failed search. Do not apply or contact anyone.

Confirm whether the task was actually created and where I can manage it. If you cannot schedule this, say so.

Check the first run

Find the saved task in your tool and check its timing, status and first result. If it was not created, reuse the prompt on demand or set a reminder. Reopen employer postings when you act, and pause alerts or tasks when your search ends.

Example: official ChatGPT scheduling instructions